Admission Policy & Procedure

1. Purpose

This Policy establishes a fair, transparent and evidence-based framework for admission to TIIS award and non-award courses. It requires approved, course-specific entry standards; reliable verification of applicant eligibility; documented admission decisions; and effective controls over offers, written agreements, payments and Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE) issuance. It supports student success and compliance with the Higher Education Standards Framework (Threshold Standards) 2021, the Education Services for Overseas Students Act 2000 and the National Code of Practice for Providers of Education and Training to Overseas Students 2018.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to all prospective domestic and overseas students seeking admission to TIIS award and non-award courses and to staff and authorised representatives involved in recruitment, assessment, admission, enrolment and CoE processing. CRICOS-specific controls apply to each active CRICOS-registered course, approved campus, delivery arrangement and intake. Agents may provide information and collect applications but may not determine eligibility or approve exceptions.

3. Definitions

Term	Meaning
Active CRICOS course	A TIIS course with current CRICOS registration for which applications or offers may be accepted.
Course Entry Requirements Register (CERR)	Controlled, course-by-course record of approved academic, English, alternative evidence, experience and other entry conditions.
Eligibility Assessment Record (EAR)	Student-specific checklist documenting each requirement, evidence examined, assessor, exceptions and approval.
Unconditional offer	An offer issued only after all admission requirements have been met and verified.
Conditional offer	An offer clearly specifying outstanding admission conditions that must be met before unconditional status or CoE issuance.
Alternative English evidence	A permitted non-standard test, qualification, prior English-medium study or internal assessment expressly authorised by applicable course and institutional requirements.

4. Policy principles

TIIS is committed to maintaining a fair, transparent, consistent and evidence-based admissions process that upholds academic standards, supports student success and complies with applicable regulatory requirements.

All admission decisions must be based on approved course-specific entry requirements, supported by verified evidence and made within clearly defined responsibilities and delegated authorities. These principles ensure that applicants are assessed equitably, admission standards are consistently applied, and decisions are properly documented, authorised and subject to appropriate oversight.

The following principles govern all admission assessments, decisions and related procedures.

- Published and course-specific: entry requirements must be clear, accurate, current and accessible for every course.
- Evidence before decision: an applicant is admitted only where required eligibility evidence has been authenticated and recorded.
- No unauthorised waivers: staff may not substitute unapproved English tests, experience or qualifications for published entry requirements.
- Separation of assessment and approval: Admissions assesses, the Academic Dean determines approved equivalencies, and the Registrar authorises final admission and CoE release.
- Auditability and fairness: decisions, reasons, approvals and supporting evidence are retained and subject to independent review.

5. Admission criteria

TIIS establishes and maintains clear, consistent and course-specific admission criteria to ensure that applicants possess the academic qualifications, English-language proficiency and other competencies necessary to undertake their chosen course successfully. Admission requirements must be consistent with approved course accreditation, applicable regulatory standards and the Course Entry Requirements Register (CERR). All applicants must be assessed against these requirements, with supporting evidence verified and documented before an admission decision is approved.

The following provisions outline the mandatory admission criteria, verification requirements and approved alternative entry pathways applicable to TIIS courses.

5.1 Mandatory course-by-course verification

The Registrar must maintain a controlled Course Entry Requirements Register (CERR) for each active CRICOS course and applicable campus or approved delivery variation, in consultation with the Academic Dean and Course Coordinator. The Academic Dean verifies academic standards and permitted pathways; the authorised officer approves each register entry in accordance with TIIS delegations. No offer may be issued using an incomplete, unverified or superseded entry. Published recruitment information must be reconciled before promotion of an intake.

For each course, the Register MUST state: (a) official course title, CRICOS code, AQF level, location and delivery mode; (b) minimum academic qualification and prerequisite disciplines or subjects; (c) minimum English test scores, component scores, permitted tests, validity and any higher course-specific threshold; (d) precisely which alternative English evidence is acceptable, its conditions and

approval authority; (e) minimum relevant work experience, if required or permitted as an equivalency pathway, including duration, recency, relevance and proof; (f) any portfolio, interview, professional registration, research proposal, prerequisite or age requirements; (g) approved pathways, credit/RPL interactions and limits; (h) source of authority, including accredited course documentation, applicable regulatory requirements and approved policy; (i) version, approval date, owner and next review date.

A general English-language or AQF-level table is indicative only and does not override approved course accreditation documentation or binding requirements. Where sources differ, the more specific binding requirement must be identified and the discrepancy resolved through the relevant academic approval process before publication or use. The Registrar must ensure consistency across the CERR, website, marketing material, application forms and Letter of Offer.

5.2 Academic entry requirements

Every applicant MUST meet the academic prerequisites recorded in the relevant course entry. Admissions must verify the authenticity, level, award status and relevance of qualifications through appropriate transcripts, certificates and verification methods. Overseas qualifications and equivalencies must be assessed using an approved documented method; any non-standard decision must be referred to the Academic Dean. RPL or credit transfer does not automatically establish admission eligibility.

5.3 English-language entry requirements

Admissions must assess English-language proficiency against the approved requirements for the particular course and intake, including accepted evidence types, overall and component scores, test validity and any permitted exemptions. Test results must be authenticated using a reliable verification method. Generic threshold tables do not authorise an otherwise unapproved test, equivalency or waiver. Any uncertainty must be referred for academic determination before an unconditional offer is approved.

5.4 Alternative English evidence — mandatory permission check

Alternative English evidence MAY be accepted ONLY where (1) the evidence type is expressly permitted by the relevant approved course requirements and applicable institutional and regulatory rules; (2) any conditions, recency and verification requirements are satisfied; (3) the Academic Dean has approved the individual equivalency or exception in writing within delegated authority; and (4) the decision and supporting evidence are recorded in the EAR. Examples potentially eligible for consideration include approved English-medium qualifications, qualifying prior study, recognised pathway completion or a TIIS internal English assessment; none is automatically acceptable for every course.

A TIIS English Placement Test MUST NOT be used for admission unless its use for the particular course is authorised in the CERR, its assessment standard and administration are approved, qualified assessors conduct the test, and the Dean documents the decision. If authority is unclear, the evidence must be treated as insufficient pending clarification; the applicant may be offered a conditional place only if appropriate, but not an unconditional offer or CoE.

5.5 Work experience and other equivalency pathways

Work experience may satisfy an entry requirement or approved alternative pathway ONLY if expressly permitted by the course's approved admission criteria. Admissions must verify employer identity, role, duties, dates, full-time equivalence and relevance through suitable records. The Academic Dean must approve any experience-based equivalency and document the academic basis for the decision. Work

experience must not be used to waive English requirements unless an independently authorised English pathway expressly allows it.

5.6 Age, student genuineness and additional criteria

Applicants must satisfy any lawful age, course-specific and overseas-student screening requirements. TIIS may undertake appropriate Genuine Student-related institutional assessment, while recognising that visa eligibility and decisions are matters for the Department of Home Affairs. Staff must use current terminology and must not represent an admission decision as a visa outcome.

6. TIIS admission procedure

TIIS implements a structured and transparent admission procedure to ensure that all applicants are assessed fairly, consistently and in accordance with approved course entry requirements, institutional policies and applicable regulatory obligations.

The admission process encompasses application assessment, verification of academic qualifications and English-language proficiency, consideration of approved alternative entry pathways, authorisation of admission decisions, issuance and acceptance of Letters of Offer, and final enrolment and Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE) approval.

Each stage must be supported by appropriate documentary evidence, clearly assigned responsibilities and effective verification and approval controls. No unconditional offer or CoE may be issued until all mandatory admission requirements have been satisfied, verified and formally authorised.

The following procedures establish the mandatory steps and responsibilities for managing admissions at TIIS.

Step 1 — Application and documentary collection

Admissions must obtain a complete application and the identification, academic records, English evidence, work-experience records and course-specific materials needed to assess eligibility. Each document must be checked for completeness and authenticity using an appropriate risk-based method. Missing, inconsistent or questionable evidence must be recorded and referred for resolution; an incomplete application must not be treated as verified.

Step 2 — Mandatory Eligibility Assessment Record (EAR)

Before an unconditional offer or CoE is authorised, Admissions must complete a student-specific Eligibility Assessment Record (EAR) against the current approved CERR. Each criterion must be marked Met, Not Met, Pending or Not Applicable and linked to its source evidence and verification method. The EAR must record document checks, English test verification, permitted alternative pathways, any Academic Dean determination, conditions, assessor identity and assessment date. A mandatory criterion marked Not Met or Pending blocks an unconditional offer and CoE.

Step 3 — Academic review and authorisation

Admissions must refer non-standard qualifications, academic equivalencies, alternative English evidence, borderline results and experience-based pathways to the Academic Dean. The Dean may approve a case only where the approved course requirements and delegated authority permit the pathway, and must document the rationale, evidence, source provision and date. The Registrar

independently checks the completed EAR, confirms that mandatory criteria are met and records the admission decision. Marketing staff and agents must not approve eligibility exceptions.

Step 4 — Issue of conditional or unconditional offer

An unconditional offer may be issued only after documented Registrar authorisation. A conditional offer may be issued where permitted, provided that each outstanding condition, acceptable evidence, deadline and decision-maker is clearly identified. Conditional status must not be represented as confirmed eligibility. The Letter of Offer must accurately specify the approved course title and CRICOS code, campus, delivery arrangements, entry requirements, dates, fees and applicable conditions. Conditions must be independently checked and formally cleared before unconditional admission or CoE release.

Step 5 — Acceptance and CoE release gate

Before issuing a CoE, the Registrar or authorised delegate must confirm: (a) the current CERR and completed EAR; (b) verified clearance of all admission conditions; (c) authentic supporting evidence and approved equivalencies; (d) the complete written agreement accepted by the student before or at the same time as TIIS receives any tuition or non-tuition fees, consistent with National Code Standard 3.1; (e) the acceptance method, agreement version, acceptance timestamp and evidence reference; (f) the payment receipt timestamp, Finance clearance and accurate fee reconciliation; (g) course, campus, duration, commencement and other PRISMS details; and (h) an independent second-person CoE check. Payment alone does not constitute acceptance. The authorised officer must record the final CoE decision. No CoE may be released while a mandatory check remains unresolved.

Step 6 — Pre-enrolment, orientation and final enrolment

Students complete orientation and pre-enrolment requirements. Registrar/Student Services ensure the student management system accurately records admission evidence, conditions, offer acceptance, CoE, enrolment and orientation. Any discrepancy must be escalated and resolved with a documented audit trail.

7. Records, monitoring and exceptions

TIIS is committed to maintaining accurate, complete and secure admission records to ensure transparency, accountability, regulatory compliance and effective institutional oversight. Appropriate recordkeeping, monitoring and corrective action processes must be implemented to safeguard the integrity of admission decisions and support continuous improvement.

The Registrar must maintain secure, controlled records of the CERR, EARs, evidence verification, admission decisions, accepted agreements and amendments, acceptance and payment timestamps, Finance authorisations, conditional-offer clearances, CoE approvals, exceptions and corrective actions.

Original records must not be backdated or retrospectively altered. All records must be retained in accordance with applicable legislation and TIIS records-management requirements.

Quality & Compliance must undertake periodic risk-based reviews, including cases involving alternative English-language evidence and previously unsigned agreements. Material findings must be reported to the CEO and relevant governance body, with corrective actions documented, monitored and verified for completion.

Any changes to approved course entry requirements must receive the appropriate academic governance approval before implementation. The Registrar must ensure that corresponding updates are made consistently across the CERR, TIIS website, marketing materials, application forms and Letters of Offer.

8. Complaints and Appeals

TIIS is committed to providing a fair, transparent, accessible and impartial process for applicants seeking a review of admission decisions or raising concerns about the admissions process.

Applicants may request a review of an admission decision or lodge a complaint in accordance with the TIIS Students Complaint and Grievance Policy.

TIIS must provide applicants with clear information about the applicable internal complaints and appeals procedures, including how to submit a request, relevant timeframes and available independent or external review mechanisms, where applicable.

All complaints and appeals must be handled fairly, impartially, confidentially where appropriate, and without discrimination or reprisal. Decisions, supporting reasons and outcomes must be documented and communicated to applicants in accordance with the applicable policy.

9. Roles and responsibilities

Effective implementation of this Policy requires clearly defined responsibilities, appropriate delegation of authority and coordination between academic governance, management and operational staff.

TIIS adopts a structured approach to admissions management to ensure that entry requirements are consistently applied, admission decisions are evidence-based, and appropriate verification, approval and monitoring controls are maintained.

The following roles and responsibilities apply to the implementation and oversight of this Policy.

Role	Responsibilities
Academic Board	Approve academic admission standards and substantive changes within its delegated authority. Oversee academic admission quality, monitor compliance with approved entry requirements and receive reports on admission outcomes and identified risks.
Chief Executive Officer (CEO) / Executive Management Team (EMT)	Ensure adequate resources, staffing and systems are available to implement this Policy. Oversee operational compliance, address significant admission risks and ensure timely corrective action.
Academic Dean	Verify course-specific academic and English-language entry requirements against approved accreditation documentation. Assess and approve permitted

	equivalencies, alternative English-language evidence and internal English assessments within delegated authority. Resolve complex academic eligibility matters.
Course Coordinator	Confirm course-specific admission prerequisites, accreditation conditions, relevant work experience requirements and any approved alternative entry pathways. Assist the Academic Dean in reviewing academic eligibility where required.
Registrar	Maintain the Course Entry Requirements Register (CERR) and oversee admission procedures. Verify completion of Eligibility Assessment Records (EARs), authorise final admission decisions, control the issuance of unconditional offers and CoEs, and ensure accurate recordkeeping and regulatory compliance.
Admissions Officers	Receive and assess applications, authenticate qualifications and English-language evidence, complete EARs, identify outstanding requirements and refer exceptions to authorised decision-makers. Admissions Officers must not approve unauthorised exemptions or waivers.
Marketing Staff and Education Agents	Provide prospective students with accurate, current and approved course and admission information. Ensure recruitment practices are consistent with TIIS policies and regulatory requirements. They must not guarantee admission or make unauthorised representations regarding entry requirements.
Quality & Compliance Manager	Conduct independent, risk-based reviews of admission decisions, student records and CoE approvals. Identify systemic compliance issues, monitor corrective actions and report material findings to the CEO and relevant governance bodies.

Accountability and Escalation

All staff involved in admissions must act within their approved delegations and promptly escalate matters involving eligibility uncertainty, unapproved exceptions, incomplete evidence or potential regulatory non-compliance.

No officer may approve an admission decision, waive an entry requirement or authorise a CoE outside their delegated authority. The Registrar is responsible for coordinating corrective actions and ensuring that unresolved mandatory admission requirements prevent unconditional admission and CoE issuance.

10. Review and document control

TIIS must ensure that this Policy and its admission requirements remain current, accurate and compliant with applicable regulatory and academic standards.

The Registrar must review the Course Entry Requirements Register (CERR) before each intake and whenever relevant accreditation, CRICOS, academic or regulatory requirements change.This Policy must be reviewed at least every three years, or earlier following significant regulatory changes, compliance incidents or audit findings.

All amendments must be approved in accordance with the TIIS Constitution, Governance Charter and Delegations of Authority. The existing approved version remains in force until the revised version is formally approved and takes effect.

11. Version Control

Version	Status	Approval Authority	Description	Date
V1.0	Approved	EMT	A1 Student Selection and Admissions Policy and Procedures (including English Assessment)	January 2019
V1.1	Approved	EMT	Revised Admission Policy & Procedure	January 2025
V2.0	Approved	Board of Directors	Approved version	25 February 2026
V2.1	Approved	EMT	Revised admission criteria, assessment procedures, verification requirements, approval controls and regulatory compliance measures	26 October 2026

Appendix A — Course Entry Requirements Register (mandatory template)

Complete a separate record for EVERY active CRICOS course and applicable campus/delivery variation.

Field	Required entry
Course title / code / CRICOS	[Complete]
Campus / delivery / intake	[Complete]
AQF level and academic prerequisite	[Complete with approval source]
English test types and minimum overall/component scores	[Complete with approval source]
Alternative English evidence permitted?	[List exact pathways or state None]
Internal English test permitted?	[Yes/No; conditions and approval source]
Work experience requirement or equivalency	[Exact duration, nature, evidence or None]
Other entry conditions	[Complete]
Approved source / accreditation version	[Document and section]
Verified by Academic Dean / date	[Sign/date]
Approved by authorised officer / date	[Sign/date]
Next review / changes to website and offer	[Complete]

Appendix B — Student Eligibility Assessment and CoE Clearance Checklist

Required check	Status / evidence reference
Correct CERR course/version used	Met / Not Met / Pending / N/A
Academic qualification and prerequisites verified	Met / Not Met / Pending / N/A
English evidence authentic and current	Met / Not Met / Pending / N/A
Alternative English pathway expressly authorised	Met / Not Met / Pending / N/A
Academic Dean equivalency approval, if needed	Met / Not Met / Pending / N/A
Work experience verified and authorised, if applicable	Met / Not Met / Pending / N/A
Other course requirements verified	Met / Not Met / Pending / N/A
All offer conditions cleared	Met / Not Met / Pending / N/A
Registrar admission approval recorded	Name / date / signature
Signed written agreement and fee checks complete	Met / Not Met / Pending / N/A
PRISMS / CoE data independently checked	Second checker / date
Final CoE release authorised	Name / date / signature

CONTROL: Any mandatory criterion marked Not Met or Pending prevents an unconditional offer and CoE issuance. Before CoE release, record the student acceptance timestamp, payment receipt timestamp, Finance clearance, Registrar approval and independent PRISMS verification.

Appendix C — Acceptance, payment and CoE audit trail (internal control)

This appendix is for TIIS internal use and must not be attached to a student-issued Letter of Offer.

Required control record	Evidence / authorisation
Student acceptance date and time	[Date/time; signature or compliant electronic acceptance; evidence reference]
Accepted agreement	[Agreement version; original accepted file location; later amendments separately retained]
Admission conditions	[Verified by; role; date; evidence reference]
Finance clearance	[Officer; date/time; acceptance verification; payment request/release reference]
Payment receipt	[Date/time; amount; receipt and reconciliation reference]
Registrar CoE clearance	[Officer; date/time; eligibility and PRISMS checks]
Independent CoE verification	[Second checker; date/time; approval reference]
Exceptions and	[Issue; action; owner; closure evidence; no backdating]

remediation	

National Code Standard 3.1 control: the student must accept the written agreement before or concurrently with receipt of tuition or non-tuition fees. Finance must verify acceptance evidence before soliciting or applying funds. Unexpected early payments must be escalated and handled without treating payment as acceptance or creating a CoE.